

“It is essential for any constitution…to make all the citizens realize…that there will be cultural autonomy; that nobody will be suppressed; that it will be a constitution which will be democratic in the true sense of the term, where, from political freedom, we will march on to economic freedom and equity.”

Dr Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, 1946

A constitution is a set of rules according to which a nation is organized and governed. It is the basis of a country’s laws and defines the powers and duties of the government, as well as citizens’ rights and duties. Indians had demanded the right to create their own constitution for decades, but it was only in 1946 that a Constituent Assembly first gathered to undertake this mammoth task.